

Netanyahu under U.S. pressure to keep peace

As Gaza agreement goes into effect, Israeli leader faces new political reality

BY GERRY SHIH AND LIOR SOROKA

JERUSALEM — After Israel and Hamas agreed on an earlier ceasefire in January, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu ended that truce after 42 days and resumed fighting in Gaza at the urging of his influential far-right coalition partners.

This time, however, he is under pressure from an even more powerful ally — President Donald Trump — to keep the peace.

The prime minister won his government's approval early Friday for a ceasefire and hostage deal based on Trump's peace plan. The agreement came into effect at midday, according to the Israeli military, which said it was pulling back "along the updated deployment lines in preparation for the ceasefire agreement and the return of hostages." Gaza's Hamas-run Interior Ministry said its security forces would deploy to areas Israeli troops were withdrawing from.

Middle East envoy Steve Witkoff said on social media that U.S. Central Command had confirmed the IDF's withdrawal to the prearranged "yellow line" and said the 72-hour period for Hamas to release the hostages had begun. The Israeli military also said Friday that Palestinians may now return to the north of the enclave, with footage from Al Jazeera and other Arabic-language media showing thousands of people beginning the journey by foot.

As Netanyahu weighs his next steps, he faces a different political landscape from earlier in the year. In Trump, Netanyahu finds an

SEE ISRAEL ON A12

Today's WorldView: Time will tell what credit Trump gets for pact. **A12**

'Iron Lady' Machado of Venezuela nets Peace Prize

BY SAMANTHA SCHMIDT AND STEVE HENDRIX

The Norwegian Nobel Committee on Friday awarded its 2025 Peace Prize to María Corina Machado, the Venezuelan opposition leader who has become a symbol of democratic resistance against an increasingly authoritarian regime, even as she has been forced into hiding and barred from holding public office.

The decision, announced in Oslo's grand City Hall, elevates Machado, known as Venezuela's "Iron Lady," from a besieged political figure in her own country to the world stage, joining the ranks of Nelson Mandela, Aung San Suu Kyi and other laureates who have challenged autocratic rule.

The White House did not issue a formal statement congratulating Machado, but Trump on Friday evening said "the person who actually got the Nobel Prize" called him to say she was "accepting this in honor of you because you really deserved it."

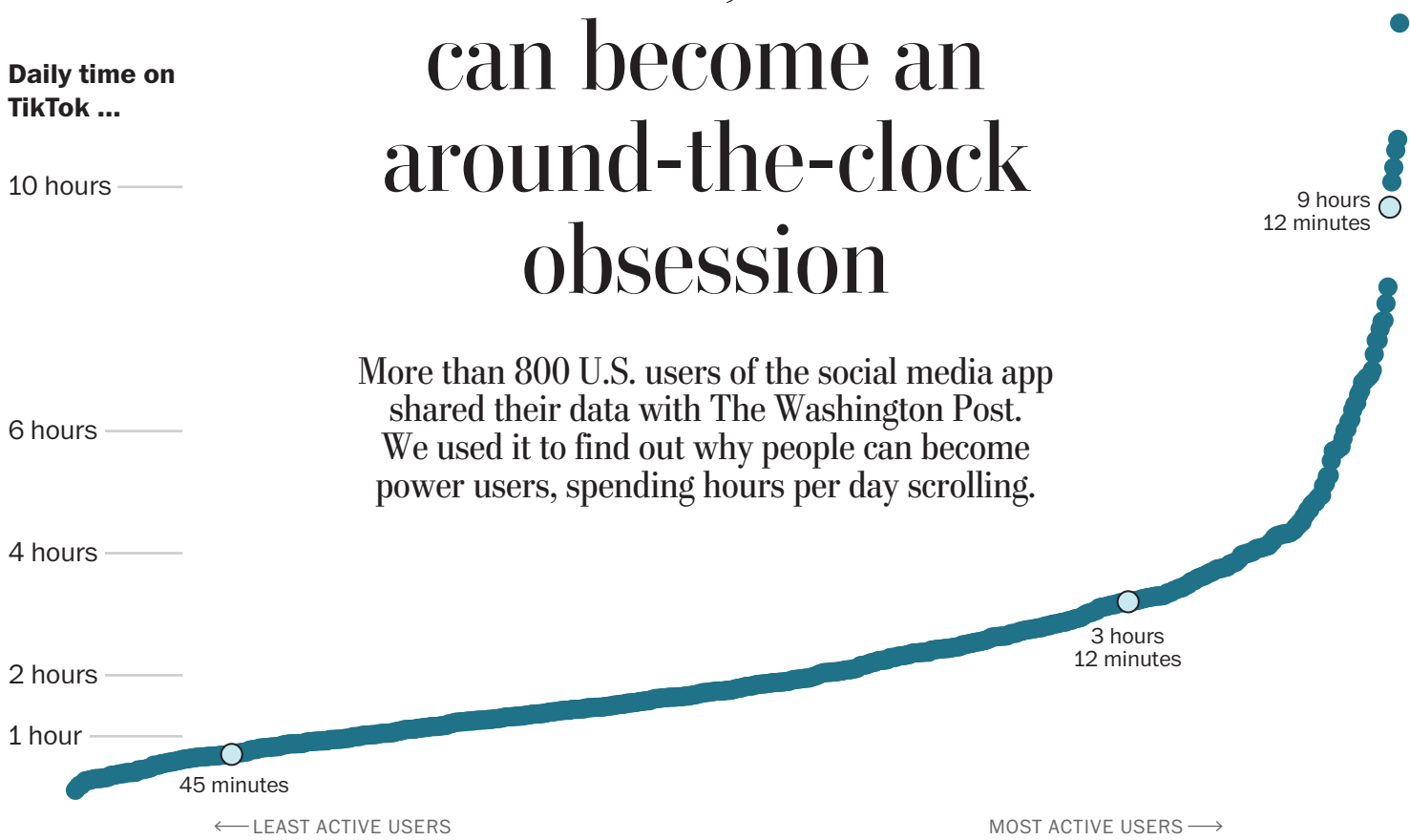
"She was very nice," Trump said. "And I've been, you know, I've been helping her along the way."

Earlier, a White House spokes-

SEE NOBEL ON A9

For some, TikTok can become an around-the-clock obsession

More than 800 U.S. users of the social media app shared their data with The Washington Post. We used it to find out why people can become power users, spending hours per day scrolling.



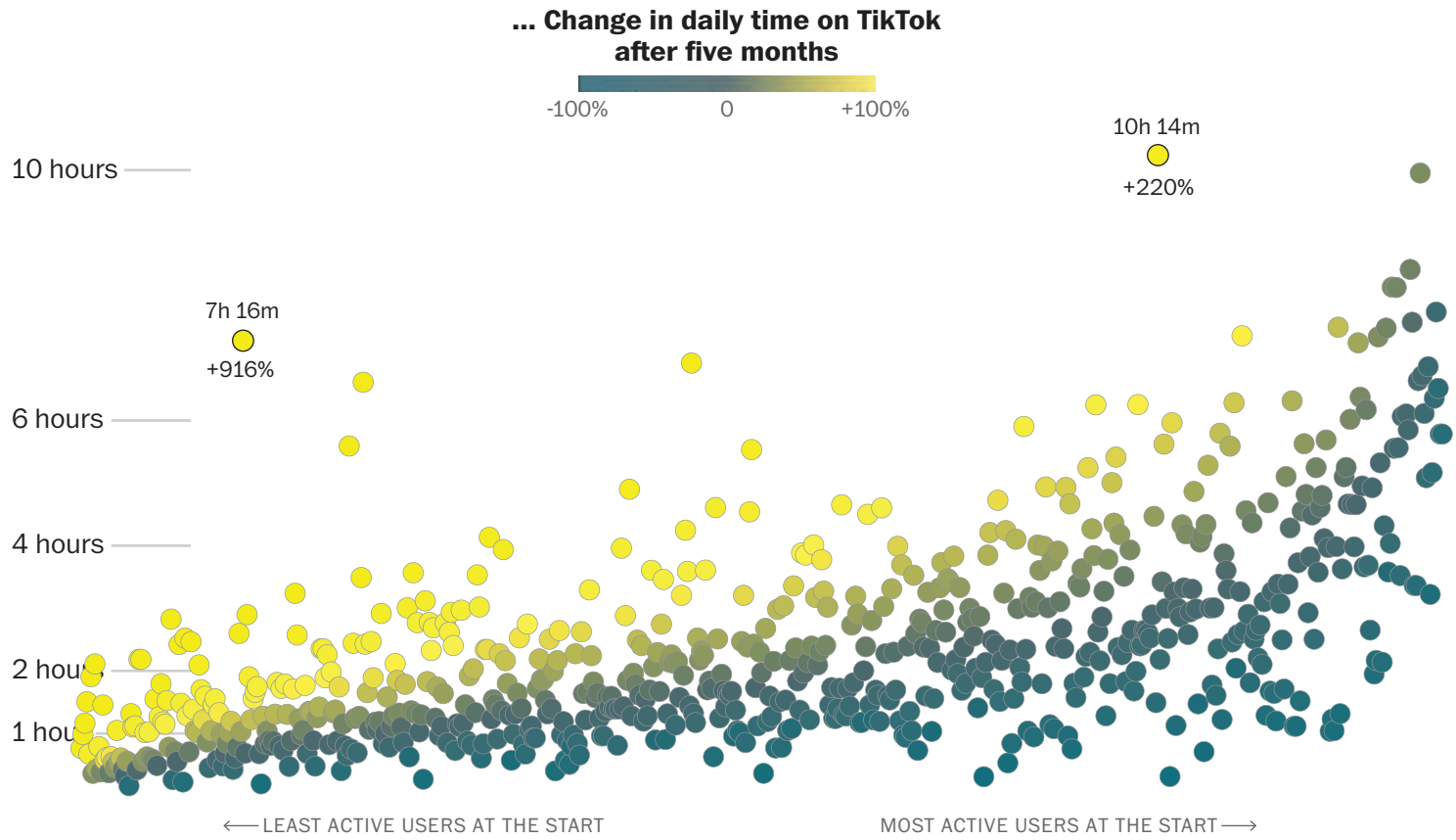
This article is by Caitlin Gilbert, Richard Sima, Leslie Shapiro, Aaron Steckelberg and Clara Ence Morse

Jon Freilich, a 51-year-old operations manager in California, described his TikTok behavior as an addiction. "I've never smoked or used drugs, so I don't know what chemical addiction feels like, but I feel like I'm addicted to TikTok," said Freilich, whose daily watch time on the app increased by more than 50 percent last year. "There are times when I know I should stop scrolling and get work done or go to sleep, but it's so hard to stop, knowing the next swipe might bring me to a truly interesting video."

That's how TikTok draws people in, with an algorithm that serves up an endless stream of hyper-personalized content to users such as Freilich.

But TikTok is massive, fragmented and opaque: Millions of Americans — a third of U.S. adults — are pulled into a nearly infinite variety of niche corners by a recommendation system that we don't know much about, making it difficult to understand how the constant scroll affects real people.

SEE TIKTOK ON A10



Surgeon general pick could expand MAHA's influence

Casey Means, Kennedy's choice for the role, has been critical of the medical establishment

BY LAUREN WEBER AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

Seven years ago, Casey Means was on a path to finishing up a highly competitive residency and becoming a well-paid surgeon. But she resigned, becoming a health products entrepreneur and popular online personality who has frequently suggested that Americans should question the advice they get from medical authorities.

"We are told to 'trust the science,'" she wrote in her 2024 book, "Good Energy: The Surprising Connection Between Metabolism and Limitless Health." "This obviously doesn't make sense. We have been gaslighted to not ask questions over the past fifty years at the exact time chronic disease rates have exploded."

As a best-selling author with more than 850,000 followers on her Instagram account,

@drcaseyskitchen, she centers her message around the concept of "good energy," which she defines as optimizing metabolic health. This idea suggests that maintaining a healthy lifestyle will ward off — and potentially treat — diseases.

Now Means, 38, is poised to become the next surgeon general of the United States, one of the nation's most recognizable and trusted medical posts. There, her backers and critics believe, she

will advance Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s "Make America Healthy Again" movement aimed at addressing childhood illness and chronic disease.

Several medical and scientific experts say she has portrayed healthy eating, an active lifestyle and using health-tracking devices as more powerful in reversing disease than scientific research has established. They are con-

SEE MEANS ON A11

Layoffs hit 4,100 across 7 agencies

TARGETED JOBS OUT OF STEP WITH TRUMP

Their legality questioned, cuts fill shutdown threat

BY HANNAH NATANSON, MERYL KORNFELD AND JACOB BOGAGE

The Trump administration began laying off federal workers Friday as the government shutdown stretched into its 10th day, fulfilling threats from President Donald Trump to take advantage of the closure to shave off more parts of the federal workforce he dislikes.

"The RIFs have begun," White House budget director Russell Vought posted on X on Friday afternoon, using an acronym for reductions in force.

The administration told a federal judge in California on Friday night that seven agencies — Commerce, Education, Energy, Health and Human Services, Housing and Urban Development, Homeland Security and Treasury — had issued RIF notices to a total of more than 4,100 workers. Lawyers for the government added that the Environmental Protection Agency had also told about 20 to 30 employees that they might be affected by a RIF in the future and other agencies are "actively considering whether to conduct additional RIFs related to the ongoing lapse in appropriations," according to the court filing.

Trump told reporters in the Oval Office on Friday that the administration deliberately moved to lay off "people that the

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A6

Thune's strategy: Senate leader is waiting for Democrats to fold. **A4**

House GOP: Patience thinning nearly a month into a recess. **A7**

Trump readies 100% tariffs on China in fresh jolt to markets

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, CATE CADELL, DAN DIAMOND AND EVA DOU

President Donald Trump on Friday said he would impose a new 100 percent tariff on goods from China, escalating tensions with Beijing after Chinese leader Xi Jinping issued new export restrictions that upended months of trade negotiations between the world's two largest economies.

Trump announced the levy shortly after the markets closed — and after stocks sank on his earlier threats to increase tariffs and cancel a meeting later this month with Xi. The Dow Jones Industrial Average was down almost 900 points, and the S&P 500 sank 2.7 percent in the biggest one-day drop since April.

The new tariffs will take effect Nov. 1 "or sooner, depending on any further actions or changes taken by China," he wrote on his Truth Social platform. Average tariffs on imports from China stand at about 57 percent, according to the Peterson Institute for International Economics, af-

SEE TARIFFS ON A13

IN THE NEWS

Sister Jean dies at 106 As chaplain for Loyola University Chicago's hoops team, she found fame during the squad's 2018 Final Four run. Her motto: "Worship, Work, Win." **A2**

Va. governor's race Fireworks erupted at a debate between Democrat Abigail Spanberger and Republican Winsome Earle-Sears. **B13**

THE NATION **Wildfires burned** less land in the West this year, thanks to quick responses and luck. **A3** **MIT's president** rejected a Trump administration deal for priority federal funding. **A5**

THE WORLD **Peru's Congress** voted to remove the president amid allegations of corruption. **A8** **A powerful** earthquake shook the Philippines, downing power lines and closing schools. **A14**

THE ECONOMY **A California law** will allow people to opt out of giving up their personal information, and you can benefit even if you don't live there. **A15** **Smart rings** can track workouts and collect health data, but often not long enough, given their battery issues. **A15**

STYLE **Kamala Harris** talks about her presidential bid and the aftermath at her book tour stop in the nation's capital. **B1** **SPORTS** **In his return** from injury, Commanders QB Jayden Daniels showed us his greatest gift: his range of possibility. **B7**

THE REGION **The region** may lose more than \$40 million for homeland security after the White House moved to cut federal grants by 90 percent. **B13** **Samuel B. Moki**, who was fired from Prince George's Office of the Environment, is a step closer to leading it. **B13**

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